

freedom as you make daily decisions about
Prioritizing work.

Prioritizing work

Each Intermediate and Senior Support Engineer should generally be prioritizing their daily work according to the following list. Interviews, training, special assignments and other time-bound commitments are examples of good temporary exceptions to these priorities.

You should think of this list as a tool for helping you to make decisions. When there are multiple things to be done, these priorities should guide you toward deciding which of them to do first.

1. Handle:

- emergencies if you are the Support Engineer On-Call, or if the Engineer On-Call needs help
- incidents if you are the CMOC
- account escalations if you are a DRI or contributing member on an active escalation

1. Handle STARred tickets that are assigned to you

- assigned tickets that are STARred will ping the assignee and on-call manager
- if your ticket is STARred during your business hours, plan to engage in the STAR thread created in the supportticket-attention-requests Slack channel to help address any questions or concerns

- if your ticket is STARred outside of your business hours, you are not expected to engage, but do plan to follow up when you're back online. The on-call manager will address any immediate needs.

1. Take tickets from the Global View, working from the top down

- for a new ticket, provide a meaningful first response within SLA
- for a rehomed ticket, let the customer know you've received their ticket, and set expectations for what will happen next

1. Participate in your Support Pods' work

1. Make sure your assigned tickets are all up to date and progressing appropriately

1. Help on tickets assigned to others by:

- posting an internal note with relevant helpful information, OR
- answering questions the assignee has posted to Slack, OR
- asking the assignee if they'd like to pair on the ticket, OR
- responding directly to the customer, preferably only if a response is needed urgently AND the assignee is unavailable to work the ticket

1. Attend to indirect ticket work you have to do, such as:

- docs updates
- issue creation or contributions
- training

Participate in on-call rotations to coordinate and resolve emergencies (Occasionally)

The following on-call rotations are staffed by Support Engineers:

1. Self-managed customer emergency on-call

1. GitLab.com Communications Manager on Call (CMOC)

All Support Engineers participate in one of these rotations - not both, unless you absolutely

love being on-call!

New Team Members: your Support Engineer Onboarding Issue shows the readiness criteria for joining rotations.

What does success look like?

- 1. Being available when you're scheduled to be on-call (learn how to swap shifts)
- 1. Responding to alerts within the required time before the alert is escalated
- 1. Successfully carrying out the on-call communication processes for .com incidents or self-managed emergencies

See the handbook for more details on Expectations for on-call.

Be sure to highlight notable incidents in your 1:1 notes doc.

Collaborate with team members and customers (Daily)

Collaboration is a core value at GitLab. You are encouraged to collaborate with Support team members, other GitLab team members, and customers to help directly and indirectly solve customer problems.

What does success look like?

- 1. Pairing sessions. You can see how you're doing on this pairing summary page
- 1. Ask and answer questions in Slack. (We don't have a way to easily make this visible, but feel free to share things you're proud of with your manager in your 1:1 notes doc.)
- 1. If you have volunteered to be a Support Stable Counterpart, collaborate with the group(s) you are assigned to and share knowledge with the Support Team.
- 1. There are many other ways you can collaborate. Make a note of your collaborations in your 1:1 notes doc.

Level	How it might look
Intermediate	Aim for two pairing sessions per week
Senior	Aim for one pairing or help session per day

Create and update issues for bugs and feature requests (Weekly)

Reducing future customer problems is an important part of being a Support Engineer. Creating, updating and escalating issues for bugs and feature requests helps achieve this.

What does success look like?

- 1. Create bug issues and feature requests whenever needed. You can see how you're doing using the 'GitLab issues' activity link in your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/issues?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=opened&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME> (replace YOURUSERNAME)

1. GitLab doesn't currently have a way to find all the comments you've made on Issues. Until this feature is available, it's hard to make your contributions to product Issues visible. Instead, be sure that your Zendesk tickets have links to the Issues that you create or update. You can also highlight contributions in your 1:1 notes doc.

Level	How it might look
Intermediate	Create issues with description completed and appropriate labels
Senior	Additionally drive fix/enhancement when appropriate based on expertise and customer interactions

Improve documentation and publicly share knowledge (Weekly)

You are encouraged to update documentation regularly. This helps prevent ticket creation by improving the information available for customers to use in solving problems without contacting us.

Creating blog posts and other publicly available knowledge that is accessible by search engines is valuable to help prevent ticket creation.

We summarize Support team contributions every week using a bot.

What does success look like?

1. Aim for at least two documentation updates every month. You can see how you're doing using the 'Docs updates' activity link in your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/mergerequests?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=merged&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME&label=documentation> (replace YOURUSERNAME)

1. If you publish information in other public places (e.g. a blog post), make a note in your 1:1 notes doc.

Fix GitLab bugs and create features (Occasionally)

Experienced Support Engineers and those familiar with programming are encouraged to fix GitLab bugs and create features.

We summarize Support team bug fixes and feature requests every week using a bot.

What does success look like?

There's no goal for this area. You can see how you're doing using the 'Support Fix' activity link in your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is: [https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/mergerequests?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=merged&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME&label=support%20Team%20Contributions¬\[labelname\]\]=documentation](https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/mergerequests?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=merged&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME&label=support%20Team%20Contributions¬[labelname]]=documentation) (replace YOURUSERNAME)

Improve GitLab and Support processes (Occasionally)

We continuously evolve and improve our processes. You are encouraged to update the handbook and

improve Support processes by contributing to issues in the Support Meta project.

There's a lot going on. It can be overwhelming if you try to contribute to everything. To help focus and find an area you're interested in look at the Support Team Epics where issues are grouped into larger initiatives. Epics have a directly responsible individual's (DRI) name in parentheses after the title. Contact them and speak with your manager if you'd like to help out.

What does success look like?

There's no goal for this area. You can see how you're doing by using the 'Handbook updates' activity link in your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/www-gitlab-com/-/mergerequests?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=merged&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME> YOURUSERNAME)

Keep up-to-date on GitLab and Support

1. Since we ship a new release every month, and as we manage to fit a lot of great new features and fixes into each release, it is sometimes difficult for the Support Team to keep up to date with key changes. In general, it is the responsibility of each Support Team member to read the release blog post, dig deeper where you need to or want to, and keep yourself up to date with new GitLab versions. To facilitate this further, there is a Retrospective every month (it is listed on the GitLab Team Meetings calendar) that you can join.

1. We have several Support Weekly Meetings that you are encouraged to attend or watch the recording of.

1. The Support Week in Review (SWIR) document is intended to contain all the recent announcements and updates each week with which everyone in Support should be familiar. You are expected to read or listen to the recording of the document every week. And you're encouraged to contribute to the document as well. You should consider putting a weekly reminder on your Monday mornings for reading (or listening to) the SWIR.

What does success look like?

There's no goal for this area. The aim is to make sure you are aware of and utilizing the information and resources that will help you stay on top of major recent changes in GitLab and the team.

Help prepare for product changes (optional)

As an extension of keeping up to date on GitLab, you're always invited to help prepare the team for changes. Occasionally, and always with every major release, there may be deprecations or breaking changes which the Support team needs to prepare for.

For major releases, typically a manager will organize the Support Stable Counterparts to review the planned changes.

Between major releases, product or development may request our assistance to contact specific users, which are handled by a group of volunteers within Support.

Each month, Support also organizes a Release Review Party (GitLab Internal only) to go over, demonstrate, and talk about new features or changes.

If you wish to participate in any of these activities, please discuss it with your manager, or the Director of Support, Global Readiness.

Develop your skills through learning and training (Weekly)

We are committed to helping you develop your skills through continuous learning. You can complete modules in the Support Training project.

The GitLab Learning and Development team provides opportunities for exploration and training.

Support Engineers are also encouraged to complete courses and certification from external providers. Speak with your manager to plan your learning goals.

What does success look like?

1. Aim to complete a module every quarter (3 months). You can see how you're doing using the 'Support Training' activity link in your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is [https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/support/support-training/-/issues?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=closed&assigneeusername\[\]=YOURUSERNAME](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/support/support-training/-/issues?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=closed&assigneeusername[]=YOURUSERNAME) (replace YOURUSERNAME)

An important focus for the Support Team in 2020 is to improve our Learning and Training resources to help you have a clear route to improving your skills and a better way to make your expertise visible to the team.

Improve our learning and training resources (Occasionally)

We encourage Support Team members to update or create Support Training resources.

What does success look like?

There's no goal for this area. If you have ideas of materials you'd like to create or update, speak with your manager. You can keep track of updates you've made using the 'Support Training Updates' activity link your 1:1 notes. Here's an example link. The format is <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/support/support-training/-/mergerequests?scope=all&utf8=%E2%9C%93&state=merged&authorusername=YOURUSERNAME> (replace YOURUSERNAME)

Help with hiring (Occasionally)

We encourage the whole team to help with the Hiring Process. If you would like to help in this area, discuss with your manager and start an Interview Training modules

What does success look like?

There's no goal for this area. When you've completed the training module:

1. Promptly respond to requests from talent acquisition to grade assessments (everyone)
1. Complete technical interviews when scheduled with you (after discussion with manager)

We'd like to make your contributions in this area more visible. Suggestions on how to do this are welcomed.

SECTION: support/support-idk.md

Support Glossary

The Support Glossary contains definitions and explanations for support-related acronyms and terms. Entries are alphabetically sorted and should link to or include a definition source when possible.

The glossary was inspired by this issue, with the goal of providing definitions for terms that might be specific to GitLab Support.

If you came to this page while reading a document with a missing definition, please update the original page with the acronym expansion, to align with the acronyms and initialisms style.

<!-- The content of this page is automatically generated from the YAML file. Do not manually add definitions. -->

<!-- To edit the definitions content for this page, go to ../../../../data/supportglossary.yml -->

{{< engineering/support-glossary >}}

SECTION: support/support-incident-response.md

Support Incident Response Framework

Support Engineers regularly encounter customer-facing incidents that require rapid, coordinated responses while maintaining technical excellence. The Support Incident Response Framework provides structure for these critical moments, helping us balance customer advocacy with effective problem-solving. It provides a structured approach that complements broader organisational incident processes while focusing on the unique requirements of customer advocacy and technical problem-solving in support contexts.

The framework delivers practical benefits through clear processes, defined roles, and systematic knowledge sharing. By transforming individual experiences into team wisdom, it reduces cognitive load during stressful situations and improves our coordination. This ultimately leads to faster resolutions for our customers while supporting our professional growth as Support Engineers.

{{% alert title="Note" color="primary" %}}

If you are seeking information to help GitLab ensure incidents are reported, investigated and handled, you might be looking for the Incident Response Guidance.

If an incident requires a non-standard workflow or communication from Support, create the Support Response issue if this has not yet been done.

If you are looking for details about being on-call in Support, you might find what you need here: [GitLab Support On-Call Guide](#)

{{% /alert %}}

In Scope

- Customer-reported production emergencies
- GitLab.com service disruptions requiring support coordination
- Security incidents requiring support response
- Mass-impact product issues
- Post-release customer impact scenarios

Out of Scope

- Pure infrastructure incidents without customer impact
- Internal system outages
- Individual customer service requests
- Feature requests and bug reports
- Non-emergency support inquiries

Integration Points

```
mermaid
flowchart LR
A[Infrastructure] --> B[Incident]
C[Security/SIRT] --> B
B --> D[Customer Success]
B --> E[Support Incident Response]
B --> F[Product]
D --> G[Coordinated Response]
E --> G
F --> G
```

```
mermaid
sequenceDiagram
participant Detection
participant Triage
participant Response
participant Communication
participant Resolution
```

Detection->>Triage: Incident Reported
Triage->>Response: Severity Assessment
Response->>Communication: Initial Response
Communication->>Resolution: Status Updates
Resolution->>Detection: Incident Closure

Working Principles

Working principles are behaviors that empower team members to carry out incident response work in alignment with the needs of our customers and our wider business Incident Response. They help illustrate what applying GitLab's core values and operating principles to your work as a Support Engineering Incident Responder will look like. These working principles are complementary to, and should be subordinate to, GitLab's core values and operating principles. In case of a conflict between the two, please create an MR to propose a change to or removal of the working principles.

Customer-First Response

Incident decisions prioritize customer impact above technical considerations. Customer experience metrics serve as primary success indicators. Response strategies target minimal workflow disruption and fastest path to resolution. Resource allocation focuses on customer-impacting components first.

Clear Accountability

Incidents operate with defined RACI matrices and explicit role assignments. Decision authority follows documented hierarchies to prevent ambiguity. Escalation thresholds trigger specific notification protocols. Critical path tasks maintain designated owners throughout incident lifecycle.

Continuous Improvement

Incidents generate standardized postmortem analysis with tracked action items. Process reviews occur at scheduled intervals with defined completion criteria. Performance metrics drive framework enhancements through data validation. Process changes undergo controlled testing before full implementation.

Incident Response Guidance

This Support Incident Response Framework is designed to complement existing organisational security and infrastructure incident response processes and should branch off established organisational workflows defined in the Incident Response Guidance.

As improvement efforts progress across the organisation, any content that appears duplicated between the Support Incident Response Framework and other incident frameworks will be identified. When duplication is detected, please create a Merge Request (MR) to remove the duplicated content from this framework and integrate it into the wider organisational incident framework.

This consolidation effort aims to create a unified approach to incident management while preserving the specialised workflows needed for customer-facing Support incidents. The Support Incident Response Framework will evolve accordingly, with emphasis on the unique aspects of customer support during incidents rather than replicating general incident procedures.

If you notice areas of duplication or opportunities for integration, please create an issue or MR in the appropriate project to help facilitate this alignment work.

Key Roles and Their Responsibilities

The Role Structure and Responsibilities component defines who does what during customer-impacting incidents, establishing clear lines of authority, communication paths, and accountabilities.

Clearly defining these roles, responsibilities, and interfaces, eliminates confusion during critical incidents and high-pressure situations, ensures comprehensive coverage of all necessary functions, and provides a foundation for continuous improvement in our incident response.

Support-Specific Roles

CMOC (Communications Manager On-call)

Primary Focus: Customer impact management and support coordination

Handbook: CMOC Workflows

- Assess the scope and nature of customer impact through tickets and monitoring
- Coordinate support team resource allocation based on incident severity
- Develop and execute the customer communications strategy
- Review and approve all customer-facing messaging for clarity and accuracy
- Create and apply incident-specific tags in Zendesk for tracking
- Handle bulk ticket responses for incident-related inquiries
- Manage support documentation and macros specific to the incident
- Coordinate with regional support teams to ensure 24/7 coverage
- Track evolving customer impact patterns throughout the incident

SMOC (Support Manager On-Call)

Primary Focus: Escalation management and support team resource coordination

Handbook: Support Manager On-Call

- Handle Support Ticket Attention Requests during incidents
- Make definitive determinations on emergency qualification
- Find additional coverage when multiple emergencies occur simultaneously
- Act as notification point for security incidents affecting support
- Lead emergency calls with customers when needed
- Assist with particularly difficult customer communications
- Prevent SLA breaches through proactive intervention

- Find Support Manager DRI for Account Escalations
- Review and validate support team response strategies

Cross-Functional Coordination

These roles are described in further detail in various handbook pages. The definitions below provide summary context for Support Engineering team members.

Incident Manager On-Call (IMOC)

- Coordinates overall incident response and technical aspects
- Manages status.io updates and public communications
- Facilitates cross-team collaboration during resolution
- Determines incident severity and closure timing

Infrastructure Team

- Provides technical resolution for platform issues
- Gives technical status updates to support teams
- Estimates resolution timeframes for customer communications
- Collaborates on post-incident analysis

Customer Success Team

- Manages communications with strategic customers
- Provides context on customer-specific needs
- Joins customer calls when appropriate
- Helps measure post-incident customer satisfaction

Product Team

- Assists with product-specific incidents and bugs
- Provides product expertise for customer communications
- Prioritizes fixes based on customer impact data
- Collaborates on bug-related messaging

Security Incident Response Team (SIRT)

- Provides security expertise during security-related incidents
- Determines appropriate information disclosure restrictions
- Guides support messaging for security incidents
- Reviews security-related customer communications

Role Interfaces and Handoffs

The framework defines clear interaction points between roles:

CMOC <-> IMOC

- IMOC provides technical status for customer communications

- CMOC provides customer impact details to inform technical priorities
- Joint approval of public-facing status updates
- Regular sync points at defined intervals based on severity

CMOC <-> SMOC

- SMOC provides guidance on complex support scenarios
- CMOC escalates resource needs and complex customer situations
- Joint decisions on emergency qualification
- Collaboration on support team resource allocation

SMOC <-> IMOC

- IMOC provides technical context for support escalations
- SMOC provides support impact details to inform response
- Collaboration on incident severity determinations
- Joint review of customer impact assessment

Regional Handoffs

- Defined documentation requirements for cross-region transfers
- Structured handoff calls at region boundaries
- Common tools and templates for consistency
- Clear escalation paths across time zones

Support-Role Engagement and Exit

Engagement Triggers

- CMOC: Multiple customers affected OR bulk communications needed OR support resource coordination required
- SMOC: Complex customer impact OR resource conflicts OR SLA risk OR SIRT involvement

Exit Criteria

- Customer communications stable
- Support queue normalized
- No new impact patterns
- Regular ticket flow resumed
- Documented final status
- Handback to regular support flow

Future considerations

<details><summary>Measuring Role Effectiveness</summary>

PROPOSED: Each role has specific KPIs to evaluate performance | ISSUE: TBC

CMOC Metrics

- Time to first customer communication
- Customer satisfaction during incidents
- Communication consistency across incidents
- Support resource utilization efficiency

SMOC Metrics

- Time to resolve escalations
- Resource allocation effectiveness
- SLA compliance during incidents
- Escalation appropriateness

</details>

<details><summary>Implementation and Training</summary>

PROPOSED | ISSUE: TBC

- Role-specific training curricula
- Regular simulation exercises
- Shadowing opportunities for new team members
- Continuous skill development pathways

</details>

<details><summary>Metrics & Success Indicators</summary>

PROPOSED | ISSUE: TBC

- Response Time
 - Description: Time from detection to initial response
 - Target: < minutes for SEV1/SEV2
- Resolution Time
 - Description: Time from detection to resolution
 - Target: Varies by severity
- Customer Satisfaction
 - Description: CSAT scores for incident handling
 - Target: > 90%

</details>

Handover Summary Templates

Summary templates as code blocks for various communication scenarios where CMOC and SMOC roles need to share information with other stakeholders in Slack channels, and/or issues.

CMOC Communication Templates

Initial Status Update Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title]

Status: In Progress

Severity: [SEV1/SEV2/SEV3]

Time Detected: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Issue Summary

[Brief description of the issue - 1-2 sentences]

Customer Impact

- Systems/services affected: [list affected services]
- Impact type: [complete outage/degraded performance/feature unavailability]
- Estimated affected customers: [number/percentage if known]

Current Actions

- [Bullet points of what the team is currently doing]

Next Update

Next status update expected by [time] UTC

Regular Status Update Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - UPDATE [X]

Status: In Progress

Severity: [SEV1/SEV2/SEV3]

Time Detected: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Last Updated: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Current Status

[Brief description of the current state - 1-2 sentences]

Progress Since Last Update

- [Bullet points of actions taken and progress made]

Ongoing Customer Impact

- [Updated impact assessment]
- Current ticket volume: [number]
- Notable patterns: [describe any patterns in customer reports]

Next Steps

- [Bullet points of planned actions]

Next Update

Next status update expected by [time] UTC

Resolution Update Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - RESOLVED

Status: Resolved

Severity: [SEV1/SEV2/SEV3]

Time Detected: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Time Resolved: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Duration: [X hours Y minutes]

Resolution Summary

[Brief description of how the issue was resolved]

Final Impact Assessment

- Systems/services affected: [list affected services]
- Total customers impacted: [number/percentage if known]
- Total tickets received: [number]

Follow-up Actions

- [Any post-incident actions customers should take]
- [Any monitoring customers should perform]

Additional Information

A full post-incident review will be conducted and findings shared as appropriate.

For any additional questions, please contact support referencing Incident [number].

Regional Handoff Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - HANDOFF

Status: In Progress

Current Region: [EMEA/AMER/APAC]

Handoff To: [EMEA/AMER/APAC]

Handoff Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Current Situation

[Brief summary of current status - 2-3 sentences]

Customer Impact Status

- Active tickets: [number]
- Pending responses: [number]
- Escalated issues: [number]

Communication Status

- Last status.io update: [time] UTC
- Next scheduled update: [time] UTC
- Draft status update: [link or text]

Priority Actions for Next Shift

1. [Most important action]
2. [Second priority action]
3. [Additional actions as needed]

Key Stakeholders

- [List of key contacts involved]

Handoff Acknowledgement

Please acknowledge receipt of this handoff in the incident channel.

SMOC Communication Templates

Support Resource Allocation Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - SUPPORT RESOURCES

Status: In Progress

Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Resource Request Type: [Initial/Update/Release]

Current Support Load

- Active incident-related tickets: [number]
- Current response time: [time]
- Queue health status: [Healthy/Strained/Critical]

Resource Allocation

- AMER: [X] engineers allocated to incident
- EMEA: [X] engineers allocated to incident
- APAC: [X] engineers allocated to incident

Priority Guidelines

1. [Top priority issue type]
2. [Second priority issue type]
3. [Standard handling for other issues]

Special Handling Instructions

- [Any special routing or handling instructions]
- [Any customer-specific considerations]

Actions Needed

- [Team leads]: [specific action requested]
- [Regional managers]: [specific action requested]
- [Other stakeholders]: [specific action requested]

Duration Estimate

This resource allocation is expected to remain in place for approximately [time period].

Customer Impact Report Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - CUSTOMER IMPACT REPORT

Status: [In Progress/Resolved]

Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Impact Summary

[Brief description of customer impact - 2-3 sentences]

Impact Metrics

- Total customers reporting issues: [number]
- Percentage of customer base: [estimated percentage]
- Geographic distribution: [regions affected]
- Customer segments affected: [Enterprise/SMB/Personal]

Common Issues Reported

1. [Most common issue] - [X] reports
2. [Second most common issue] - [X] reports
3. [Third most common issue] - [X] reports

Customer Sentiment

- Current CSAT trending: [Stable/Declining/Improving]
- Notable customer concerns: [list major themes]

Recommended Actions

- [Technical team]: [recommended action]
- [Communications team]: [recommended action]
- [Customer success]: [recommended action]

Additional Information

[Any other relevant details about customer impact]

CMOC Activation Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - CMOC ACTIVATION

Status: In Progress

Activation Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Requested By: [Name/Role]

Activation Criteria Met

- [List specific criteria that triggered activation]

Current Support Status

- Active tickets: [number]
- Affected customers: [number/types]
- Current response time: [time]

Initial CMOC Actions

1. [First immediate action]
2. [Second immediate action]
3. [Ongoing monitoring focus]

Resource Requirements

- Personnel needed: [specific roles/numbers]
- Tools/access needed: [specific requirements]
- Stakeholder engagement needed: [specific teams]

Actions Needed

- [CMOC]: Acknowledge activation and implement response plan
- [Regional managers]: [specific action requested]
- [Technical teams]: [specific action requested]

Communication Plan

- Initial customer communication to be sent by: [time]
- Coordination meeting scheduled for: [time]
- Reporting cadence: [frequency]

Post-Incident Support Summary Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - SUPPORT SUMMARY

Status: Resolved

Incident Duration: [start time] to [end time] UTC

Report Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Support Response Summary

[Brief overview of the support response - 3-4 sentences]

Key Metrics

- Total tickets handled: [number]
- Peak tickets per hour: [number]
- Average response time: [time]
- Support resources utilized: [number of staff]

Customer Impact Analysis

- Most affected customer segments: [details]
- Geographic distribution: [details]
- Common workarounds provided: [list]

Effectiveness Assessment

- What worked well: [bullet points]
- Improvement areas: [bullet points]
- Tool/process gaps identified: [bullet points]

Follow-up Actions

- [Specific action items with owners and timelines]

Lessons Learned

[Key takeaways for future incident response]

Cross-Functional Templates

Technical-to-Support Handoff Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - TECHNICAL TO SUPPORT HANDOFF

Status: [In Progress/On Hold/Resolved]

Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Technical Summary

[Brief technical explanation of the issue - keep simple and customer-focused]

Customer-Facing Impact

- What customers are seeing: [observable symptoms]
- Affected components/features: [specific details]
- Scope of impact: [broad/limited/specific customers]

Workaround Instructions

[Step-by-step workaround if available]

Customer Communication Guidance

- Key points to communicate: [bullet points]
- Points to avoid mentioning: [bullet points]
- Technical accuracy verified by: [name]

Expected Resolution

- Estimated time to resolution: [timeframe if known]
- Fix delivery method: [hotfix/regular release/etc.]

Actions Needed

- [Support team]: [specific guidance on ticket handling]
- [CMOC]: [guidance on status.io messaging]
- [Other teams]: [any other coordination needed]

Executive Update Template

markdown

Incident [number] - [title] - EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Status: [In Progress/On Hold/Resolved]

Time: [YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC]

Situation Overview

[Concise explanation of the incident - 1-2 sentences]

Business Impact

- Customer impact: [High/Medium/Low] - [brief description]
- Revenue impact: [Yes/No/Unknown] - [brief description if Yes]
- Reputation risk: [High/Medium/Low] - [brief explanation]

Response Status

- Technical response: [On track/Delayed/Blocked] - [brief status]
- Support response: [On track/Delayed/Blocked] - [brief status]
- Communications: [On track/Delayed/Blocked] - [brief status]

Key Metrics

- Duration so far: [time]
- Estimated time to resolution: [time or unknown]
- Support tickets: [number]
- Affected customers: [number/percentage]

Critical Decisions Needed

[List any decisions requiring executive input]

Next Update

Next executive update scheduled for: [time] UTC

These templates provide structured frameworks for different types of communications that CMOC and SMOC roles would need to share with stakeholders during an incident. They're designed to be clear, actionable, and adaptable to different incident scenarios while maintaining consistency in format.

SECTION: support/support-stable-counterparts.md

Overview

As a result of our direct interactions with customers, the Support Team occupies a unique position in GitLab that gives us the opportunity to connect product managers with customer feedback, and influence changes. To take advantage of this opportunity, we've adopted a model that is known within GitLab as "Stable Counterparts." In brief, a "stable counterpart" is an assigned, permanent contact for a GitLab Team Member within another function in the company. See the Stable counterparts item on the Leadership page, and An ode to stable counterparts for more information.

Expected outcomes

- SSCs act as a bridge between the wider Support team and the Product groups to share information both ways.
- SSCs become the voice of the customer in product forums, and can influence product decisions.
- SSCs are enabled to develop vertical subject matter expertise in certain product areas.
- Product teams have a simple way to understand and explore various customer use cases and gather feedback.

How do we align Support Team Members to the Product?

- Development of the product is broken down into sections, stages and groups; that page is the single source of truth about who is performing this role.
- Each group can have one or more individual contributor counterparts.
- Each section can have a Support manager counterpart.

Expectations from an SSC

Establish and maintain a relationship with your product group(s)

Just like us, the product teams are spread across the globe. Due to this, it might not always be possible to sync with your counterparts.

- If time zones permit, have an introductory coffee chat with your Product Manager.
 - Talk about your interest in the group, and why you chose to become an SSC in it. Ask about the team and their day-to-day.
 - Ask them about their expectations of the SSC. Manage them and align.
- If you are in non-overlapping time zones, do a handshake via Slack.
- Establish a regular cadence for communication with them.
 - Using a living Google document helps, especially for maintaining a regular async communication model. You can make use of this template for it.
- In the initial introduction,
 - Get yourself added to their team sync - you can read the agenda doc if you're unable to join the sync call!
 - Join their Slack channel.
- If the group you chose already has an SSC, schedule a coffee chat with the existing counterpart to learn more!
- [Section SSC] Schedule a coffee chat with the Support counterparts in the groups within the section.

Be alert and engaged on what's happening with the group

- Subscribe to the pertinent trackers and labels to be aware of new issues in that group.
- Be aware of major issues (especially severity::1) in the product area, including workarounds.
- Be aware of the tickets raised by customers pertinent to the category, surfacing and advocating for them.
- Be aware of major changes related to the group in upcoming releases. At the section level, awareness of major changes will be 6+ months away instead.
- Inquire about the group's plans for breaking changes in the next major release well in advance (three months/releases prior). Try to get a proper understanding of how customers will be affected early on.
- Be aware of the priorities and challenges of the product group.
- Strive to become a subject matter expert in the use of the features they cover. At the section level, focus on becoming knowledgeable on feature usage and effect on customers.
- Consider adding yourself as a CC to the RFH issue template for your product group. This ensures you will be notified anytime someone in Support needs to reach out to your group via an issue. You might be able to provide additional context, help your colleague or just benefit from increased awareness yourself.
- [Section SSC] Provide insight into relevant product KPIs and their potential impact on

customers and Support.

Enable Support with periodic communication relevant to the group

- A monthly communication cadence is recommended. Since your group might not have a lot of updates to share with Support every month, set a cadence that is appropriate for the situation.
 - Support's Monthly Business Review can serve as natural check-in via the SSC Feedback slides you're supposed to update.
- Share announcements through the SWIR and in relevant Support Slack channels.
 - Use the prefix [SSC Update: GroupName: GitLab(Major).(Minor).(Patch)] for your updates in both SWIR and in relevant Slack channels. This consistency helps highlight the impact and significance of the SSC role.
- Group related updates and announcements can be:
 - New features added in an upcoming release
 - Bug fixes in an upcoming release
 - Issues likely to generate tickets
 - Issues that may be good contribution opportunities
 - Major documentation changes
 - Discovered bugs and applicable workarounds
 - Any special processes or troubleshooting workflows that might pertain to the features in your group
- Any changes in Support's workflows as a result of changes from your group
- If you have not had any updates to share in a long time, consider sending out a quick "Nothing major you have to watch out for with this release, all is well!" or "Here is an awesome new unfiltered video on this topic" etc.
- Catalyze training materials and sessions as needed.
- [Optional] Consider doing quarterly office hours to chat about your group and share your experiences as an SSC with newer team members.
- [Optional] Be the DRI or ensure to find a DRI on any [Support Preparedness issue from your product group to ensure major changes are widely communicated.
- [Section SSC] Ensure a regular cadence of communication with the group level SSCs to ensure alignment and balance of prioritization of issues.

Enable Product with periodic communication relevant to the group

- Share customer feedback from tickets with the Product team.
 - Loop them in to relevant issues, tickets and Slack threads.
- Be the customers' voice and an influencing agent on product related decisions and future roadmap.
- [Optional] Help with questions in the Product team's Slack channels.

Examples of SSC activities

There's many different groups, and no one approach to being a SSC will be the perfect fit for all. Finding out how to best work with your group can take a while (one Senior Support Engineer said it took them more than two years to feel they really figured it out), and as everything at GitLab it is an iterative and · hopefully · transparent process. The expectations listed in the section above are a good starting point, but they are neither compulsory nor can they be complete.

Here's some things that other SSCs are doing that might serve as additional inspiration:

- Helping with UX research: As a Support Engineer, you're uniquely qualified to help defining good "real life" test scenarios and creating environments for them (example from Pipeline Authoring)
- Helping with Product design: When product designers plan upcoming features, you can look at those plans from the perspective of what kind of problems customers are likely to run into and how to avoid it (example for Authentication and Authorization)
- On a cadence, identify and tag or list relevant Support tickets you've worked on or seen (examples for Pipeline Authoring, Pipeline Execution)
- Tag issues with "Support Priority" and "Support Efficiency" when appropriate. You can also use "Support Interest" to easily search for issues.
- Analyze impact of fixing one or more high priority issues with the number of relevant tickets. (examples for Authentication and Authorization and SaaS Account tickets)
- Contacting customers on behalf of the product group: Normally this is something the CMOC does, but in non-urgent cases you might be better equipped with domain-specific knowledge for a specific conversation with a customer (example from Pipeline Execution)
- Provide reviews of customer enablement campaigns: The Customer Success Programs Team creates campaigns to inform and educate our customers to help expand their usage of GitLab. As an SSC you're uniquely positioned as a Subject Matter Expert to review the communication that will go to customers with an eye for technical accuracy and ticket deflection. See SME Review Guidelines for more information.
- Check if there is a Support Pod that is topically aligned with your product group and consider joining it · you're an ideal candidate to benefit from the additional exposure to relevant tickets.

Be available to support and mentor newly onboarded SSCs

- Being an SSC is a different experience based on the group. However, you will have certain tried and tested best practices that will help newly onboarded SSCs. Consider sharing them with the other SSCs in the team.
 - Use the [@gitlab-com/support/support-stable-counterparts](#) GitLab group, and [sptstable-counterparts](#) Slack channel to share best practices with other SSCs, and to gather input and feedback on process changes, improvements and other discussions.
 - This Slack channel has both Slackbot's reminder app and Geekbot enabled to encourage channel participants to share periodic updates.
- Iterate on this page and other aspects of the process based on what works and what doesn't in the real world so that future SSCs can benefit from your learnings.

Raise concerns with your manager if unable to set aside required time to be an SSC

- Your success in the SSC role depends on your ability to build and maintain a relationship with the Product team. You will need to dedicate time to it regularly.
- If you find yourself unable to do justice to the expectations, have a chat with your manager and let them help you with time management and prioritization.
- It is perfectly alright to step aside for a few weeks and get back into it again once you have the bandwidth to do so.

Expectations from Managers

- If you are managing a Support Engineer who is also an SSC, it should be a topic of conversation in your 1:1 with them at least once a month.
 - Enable them in prioritizing and setting aside time for this activity.
 - Work on resolving concerns if any.
- If a Support Engineer you manage is interested in becoming an SSC, point them to the following section on How can I enroll and be a counterpart?.
- If the SSC is going to be unavailable for a prolonged period of time, or, during an important event related to their group, act as their backfill.

Expectations from the Product Teams

- Please be aware of time zone constraints and flex to accommodate the SSC.
 - Introduce new SSCs to your team and add them to the relevant channels, documents and meetings.
 - Engage async via a doc or discuss other modes of communication with the SSC.
- Share all relevant updates with the SSC, either sync or async.
- Each SSC-PM relationship is going to be different, work on finding out what works best for you and them!
- Share feedback with Support on what is working and what isn't.
- Set and manage expectations to get the most out of this!

If your group doesn't have an SSC assigned and you'd like to request one, please create an issue in the support-stable-counterpart project and share in supportteam-chat and sptstable-counterparts.

Current SSC Vacancies

The tables below lists all groups and stages that currently do not have an SSC assigned. You can view a list of groups where a Product and/or Engineering Manager has reached out to support requesting an SSC in the support-stable-counterpart project.

How can I enroll and be a counterpart

If you're interested in becoming a stable counterpart for a group,

- Discuss with your manager.
- Open an issue with the SSC Onboarding template in the Support Training project.
 - This is a very short module that walks you through expectations and best practices, and will take less than half a day to complete!
- Once done, create a handbook merge request:
 - Add your name under 'Support' for the relevant team on /data/stages.yml. Spell your name exactly as in the YAML file for your team page entry to ensure it will be linked up correctly.
 - Assign the MR to your manager.

Note: We encourage having more than 1 SSC for a group - so if the group you are interested in already has an SSC, don't let that deter your interest!

Non-group specific SSCs

A couple of roles are not product group specific, but involve all the same expectations and

responsibilities.

Non-group specific counterparts typically also step in when the related group has questions where there is no SSC currently.

Section	Group	Group Contact	Support Counterpart	Frequency
:-----: :-----: :-----: :-----: :-----:				
Finance	Accounts	TBD		
TBD		N/A		
Finance	Budget	{{< member-by-name "Chase Wright" >}}		
TBD		1x Qtr on budget + once per month		
Legal	Legal	{{< member-by-name "Robin Schulman" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Lee Matos" >}}		{{< member-by-name "Val Parsons" >}}		N/A
PeopleOps	After-hire care	{{< member-by-name "Jessica Mitchell" >}}		
TBD		N/A		
PeopleOps	Talent Acquisition	{{< member-by-name "Cyndi Walsh" >}}		
TBD		N/A		
Performance	Performance	{{< member-by-name "Stan Hu" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Lee Matos" >}}		N/A		
Production	.com Infrastructure	{{< member-by-name "Dave Smith" >}}		
TBD		N/A		
Marketing	Developer Relations	{{< member-by-name "John Coghlan" >}}		
TBD		N/A		
Marketing	Open Source Prog.	{{< member-by-name "Bryan Behrenshausen" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Andrew Conrad" >}}		weekly team meeting		
Customer Success	Customer Success	{{< member-by-name "Kristen Lawrence" >}}		
TBD		weekly on Fri join EMEA scrum		
Sales	Sales	TBD		
{{< member-by-name "Mike Dunninger" >}}		{{< member-by-name "Tine Sørensen" >}}		N/A
Security	Security Operations	{{< member-by-name "Jan Urbanc" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Brie Carranza" >}}		N/A		
UX	Tech Writing	{{< member-by-name "Susan Tacker" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Mike Lockhart" >}}		weekly team meeting		
Quality	Reference Architecture	{{< member-by-name "Grant Young" >}}		
{{< member-by-name "Simon Street" >}}		N/A		

Product counterparts

{{< engineering/section-counterparts >}}

{{< engineering/stages-counterparts >}}

SECTION: support/support-time-off-buddies.md

Overview

When you have upcoming time off, it can be daunting to prepare your tickets

before you're out. Sometimes, this can even lead us to avoid taking time off due to the stress of dealing with ongoing tickets. While your peers and managers are here to help, it can be difficult to ask for this help for some folks. In order to help out with these challenges, consider finding a Support time off buddy!

Time off buddies are intended to help tackle the following common problems:

- 1. Reduce burden of taking time off
- 1. Provide continuity for customers and reports while out of office
- 1. Help keep each other accountable for taking time off
- 1. Help keep each other accountable for not checking in with work during time off
- 1. Provide opportunities for focus days

The initial trial

We trialed the time off buddy system in 2022. You can find the original proposal and further discussion in the Support Team Meta issue.

The original trial buddies were:

Aric Buerer	Izzy Fee	
Bo Carbonell	Brie Carranza	
Keelan Lang	Julie Martin	
Sam Bernal-Damasco	Eric Rosenberg	

If you have questions about the method, please reach out to any of the original participants to get their thoughts!

Responsibilities

At a minimum, time off buddies are expected to review their buddy's tickets each day until their buddy returns, and take action on tickets as needed. This does not mean that buddies must take ownership of the tickets. Instead, a buddy should be prepared to take action if a ticket needs attention. This may include:

- Finding another resource to take over
- Communicating with the customer that the assignee is out of office, and discussing if the customer is okay to wait for the assignee to return
- Alerting a manager of any spicy tickets or customers

Since this is intended to be a low barrier program, the base responsibilities are intentionally simple. Time off buddies should work together to outline any additional responsibilities or expectations.

Choosing a buddy

We need to tell people how to choose buddies!

Tips

Each engineer should manage their responsibilities in a way that works for both buddies. To get started, here are things that we had success with in the trial:

- Set up a "time off" pairing session with your buddy 1-2 days before you plan to be out of office to discuss your open tickets and other expectations.
- Set up a "catch-up" pairing session with your buddy 1-2 days after your return to get up-to-speed on the state of your tickets.
- Inform your buddy of upcoming out of office as soon as it's scheduled
- Set your buddy as covering for ticket reopens (and other agreed-upon responsibilities) in Time Off by Deel.

Use pairings

When preparing to leave for time off, or when returning from time off, consider using a pairing session to keep your buddy informed.

Use internal ticket comments

Put a brief comment explaining the state of a ticket and expected next steps before leaving for time off. This also helps in the event that your buddy needs to hand off your ticket to someone else in your absence.

Use Zendesk views

You can set up a Zendesk view to track your buddy's tickets while they're out.

FAQ

Am I in charge of my buddy's tickets while they're out?

Your buddy is not expected to take over your tickets while you are out, but they should serve as the interim DRI to help progress any of your active tickets. See responsibilities for more info.

Should I use my time off buddy for holiday coverage?

You can use the time off buddy system however it works for you. However, please follow the Support team guidelines around holiday time off ticket management to ensure that all Support coverage goals are met.

Does my buddy need to be in the same region as me?

Where possible, you should follow the guidelines for choosing a buddy to ensure the best coverage. You may have a buddy in another region, as long as it works for you and helps, rather than

hinders.

How many people can I be a buddy for?

Ideally, buddy pairing should be 1 to 1. This lets you tailor a system that works best for both engineers, so that you can get the most out of the system.

If you'd like, you can have more than one time off buddy. In this case, be sure to keep the manager of one value in mind. It can be tempting to help as many people as possible, but don't let it be to your own detriment.

SECTION: support/support-time-off.md

Support Team Member Time Off

The Support Team follows GitLab's paid time off policy.

We balance that with the need to deliver support to our customers every day.

This page is intended to provide all Support Team Members with an understanding of what we need to do to achieve that balance, making it possible for all to take time off as needed and desired, while we as a team continue to deliver amazing support and service to our customers.

There is a special point that needs to be emphasized, and that is that time off for any team member only serves its purpose if that person truly takes the time off. Nobody should feel pressure or the need to check Slack, email, or anything else associated with work during their time off. Especially when you are taking time to be on holiday or to be with family or friends, please, in the timeless words of the snow queen, Elsa, "let it go."

One-time setup actions

Support Time Off calendars

1. Be sure you have access to the Support - Time Off team calendar.

1. You should have been granted access during Support Onboarding. If you don't have it, verify whether you are part of the Support Google Group (supportteam@); if you are not, ask to be added (as per the role based entitlements) via the supportoperations Slack channel (cc @jcolyer).

1. Set up the Google Calendar integration with Time Off by Deel, so that you do not need to populate your personal and "Support - Time Off" calendars manually.

1. In Slack, click the + sign next to 'Apps' at the bottom of the left sidebar

1. Search for 'Time Off by Deel' and click 'View'

1. Under 'Home', click on 'Your Events' to show a dropdown

1. Click on 'Calendar Sync' under the Settings break

1. Click on 'Connect your Calendar' and complete the actions to sync your calendar to Time

Off by Deel

- You will see a 'Success! Your calendar has been connected.' message and your calendar listed under 'Your synced calendar' in Time Off by Deel on Slack
- NOTE: this also serves to block your availability in Calendly, and ensures your OOO is

included in the regional capacity calendars

1. After your personal calendar is linked, click 'Add calendar' under 'Additional calendars to include?'. The 'Support - Time Off' calendar ID is gitlab.comas6a088eo3mrvo57n5kddmgdg@group.calendar.google.com

1. Verify the following calendars are shared with you. These are shared with the Support Team Google Group:

1. Support OOO - AMER
1. Support OOO - APAC
1. Support OOO - EMEA

1. You can subscribe by clicking the Add to Google Calendar button at the bottom left of the regional calendar.

1. You can also subscribe to these calendars directly by using the following ID's

- Support OOO - AMER -

c9166d2302886c4ae23f34099eeb4015e2d520e1dd4029711becd8370be996513@group.calendar.google.com

- Support OOO - APAC - c408bhp8a8j579lqr99j552u21s@group.calendar.google.com

- Support OOO - EMEA - cev56c9rgjd9l1sn291i368jn78@group.calendar.google.com

1. If you regularly handle L&R tickets, please subscribe to the global L&R calendar and relevant L&R regional calendar.

L&R and USGov Calendar links

Group			
----	----	----	----
L&R	APAC	EMEA	AMER
US Gov	Daytime	Evenings	Overnight

Manager Calendar Links

- Support Managers AMER

Choosing and recording time off

Please take time off whenever you need it.

A little thoughtfulness on everybody's part will go a long way toward making it possible for everyone to take their desired days off. As you look to plan your time off, please:

- ensure you know the company wide paid time off guidelines
- consider a different time off schedule if your regional capacity calendar shows that on any of the days you would be absent, the regional team would be short by 20% or more of its people
- check the regional calendar and coordinate with your manager to ensure we have sufficient cover for days with low availability. You can do this by ensuring that you are subscribed to your associated regional calendar (i.e., EMEA - OOO, AMER - OOO, APAC - OOO) and that prior to booking time off, you check the calendar:
 - · Green: You're good to book PTO.

- · Yellow: The team is nearing PTO capacity · consider other dates if possible.
- · Red: PTO capacity has been reached. Please discuss with your manager before proceeding.
- the calendar colors are determined by the percentage of engineers on PTO:
- · Green: 0-15% of engineers on PTO
- · Yellow: >15% to 20% of engineers on PTO
- · Red: >20% of engineers on PTO
- schedule your time off as far in advance as you can, especially for days that may be popular, are holidays, or that are particularly important to you
- don't lock yourself into nonrefundable travel itineraries before you've taken steps such as the above to be sure you can get the planned days off
- if possible, plan your time off to avoid disruptions to the various rotations such as on-call

Preparing for time off

When you are approaching a planned absence from work, it is your responsibility to take reasonable actions to prepare the team and your customers for your absence. By making these preparations, you will also be making it easier for yourself to disconnect from work and make your time off effective.

If you're taking off less than half a day, you do not need to make entries in Workday or the Support Time Off Calendar, but please consider updating your Slack status. Also consider blocking the interval on your personal Google Calendar, so no one tries to book a pairing/meeting with you during that time.

If you're taking off a half day or more, enter the time off in Workday.

At the end of your last work day before taking PTO, update your availability using the Out of Office app in Zendesk. This is done by navigating to the app in Zendesk and clicking the Make unavailable button on the row with your user information in it.

Follow the guidance below to prepare yourself, your customers, and your colleagues.

Coverage for roles

If you are assigned to any PagerDuty shifts (such as on-call) during the time off, arrange for coverage:

1. Find a volunteer to cover for you; get help from your manager if necessary.
1. Create the appropriate override in PagerDuty.

Coverage for assigned tickets

Tidy your queue before going on PTO. As guidelines cannot cover every case, this section is meant to provide guidance for you to think critically about what is required to ensure continued excellent support for each customer with whom you're working on a ticket.

If your absence will be less than three business days

If your PTO will prevent a timely update, ask the customer whether

they would prefer to pause the ticket with the on-hold status or have someone else step in.

For high priority tickets, tend towards a handing over to someone else:

1. Use the OOO Ticket Summary macro, providing the same information as described in the Workflow topic of the OOO Ticket Management page.

If your absence is three or more business days

1. Change your workflow in advance of your absence:
 1. A week in advance: Start thinking about whether you may need to hand off tickets, and pair with others to get them up to speed.
 1. Two to three days in advance: stop taking new tickets.
 1. Work to resolve and close as many of your assigned tickets as possible.
 1. Contribute more to first responses and other people's tickets - internal comments, pairing sessions - to make up for not taking new tickets of your own.
1. Follow the OOO Ticket Management process to arrange for others to take care of your tickets in your absence.
1. To ensure you're not auto-assigned to GDPR requests in case of an extended leave (e.g 2 weeks or longer):
 - Update the corresponding yaml file for yourself in the Support Team project.
 - Change worksaccountdeletion: true to worksaccountdeletion: false
 - Request a review from your manager.
 - Make sure to undo this change when you return from OOO.
1. After coming back, make sure to follow the guidelines for catching up after a scheduled time off.

How Support Handles Family and Friends Days

During Family and Friends Days GitLab Support continues to operate as normal. In FY26, you are free to take off a total of 4 days at your convenience, to celebrate and record as Family and Friends day. Please follow the same guidelines as you would in Choosing and Recording Time Off.

How Support Handles Holidays

During Holidays, GitLab Support continues to operate as normal. Always book holidays as required by your locality. For non-statutory holidays, please follow the same guidelines as you would in Choosing and Recording Time Off.

Holiday time off ticket management

Guidance around ticket handling over global holiday time off is slightly different, because of the potentially increased impact on the Support team.

The following peak holidays have the greatest potential to affect coverage:

- Australia Day (26-January)
- Republic Day (26-January)
- Anzac Day (25-April)
- International Workers Day (1-May)
- Memorial Day (last Monday in May)
- Independence Day (1-July to 4-July)
- US Thanksgiving Day (4th Thursday of November)
- Immaculate Conception Day (8-Dec)
- Christmas Day, St Stephens Day, Boxing Day, New Years Day and Day After New Years (Period between 24-Dec to 2-Jan)
- Holidays that vary in dates each year that are celebrated in multiple countries:
 - Easter Sunday (late March to early April)
 - Easter Monday (late March to early April)
 - Whit Monday (May or June)
 - Ascension Day (May)
 - Labour Day (first Monday in September)

If you are planning to take time off during peak holidays

If you plan to be out for more than three days, follow the guidance regarding absences of three or more business days.

Otherwise:

1. Please do your best to resolve any assigned tickets you have in your queue.
1. Communicate with your customers to let them know the days you'll be away, and to ask whether they will need help during your absence. Many of our customers might be on the same holiday schedule and will be fine with resuming work on a ticket when you both return.
1. For those tickets that will not require action over the holiday, there is no special action to be taken.

If you are working on a holiday

1. Continue to prioritize FRT first, and then management of your own tickets.
1. Please pay extra attention to NRT on tickets with an assignee who is currently out-of-office.

General Tips

In addition to the company-wide tips in *Communicating Your Time Off*, take a look at these tips to increase your ability to disconnect from work, truly make the most of your time off, and make it easier to return to work:

1. Unsubscribe from any MRs that will likely resolve while you're away, and then you won't have to deal with all the emails from them when you return.
1. Set up some email filters to move emails into buckets that you can address one-at-a-time when you return.

1. Disconnect yourself from Slack and Gmail in any of these ways:

NOTE: Time Off by Deel is supposed to turn off Slack notifications on your phone and set DND mode. But just in case, you may want to do one of these:

1. log out from Slack and Gmail on your phone, or
1. remove Slack and Gmail from your phone, or
1. pause the Slack and Gmail apps on your phone
1. manually configure Slack and Gmail to send no notifications on your phone

Re-connect after time off

Please consider adding an item in the Support Week in Review after you get back to let the rest of the team know what you've been up to!

Catching up after a scheduled time off

Trying to catch-up after a scheduled time off - especially if it's a week long, or more - can be a bit overwhelming.

So here is a list of resources to check that should get you up to date with almost everything that happened while you were away:

- Support Week in Review (SWIR)

- Slack channels:

- company-fyi
- company-fyi-private
- whats-happening-at-gitlab

Consider setting up a few coffee chats with teammates to simply reconnect with them. You can also ask your teammates who haven't taken PTO while you were out, during coffee chats or pairing sessions, to mention a thing or two that you might have missed.

Once you have taken the time to catch-up, update your availability using the Out of Office app in Zendesk showing you are no longer OOO. This is done by navigating to the app in Zendesk and clicking the Make available button on the row with your user information in it.

If you unassigned some of your tickets before going on PTO, take the time to go th